

## Product Requirements Document

# Project 0 — Portfolio Shell

✓ APPROVED · April 2026

## 1 · PROBLEM STATEMENT

The Visionary Staller (Persona #1) is concurrently learning software product management and generating proof of that learning through personal projects — but has no medium to display or share that work. Without a portfolio, the learning stays invisible and the employment goal stays out of reach.

The Hiring Evaluator (Persona #2) needs to assess candidate fit within seconds of page load. They will not wait for context to accumulate — competency must be legible immediately, with compelling enough evidence to warrant a deeper look.

Project 0 — the Portfolio Shell — exists to solve both problems simultaneously: it gives Persona #1 a live, public showcase for their PMD work product and mindset, and it gives Persona #2 the fast, credible signal they need to decide a candidate is worth a conversation.

## 2 · GOALS & SUCCESS METRICS

Project 0 succeeds when a hiring evaluator can land on a live, public URL, understand what PM Dev builds and how they think, see real PMD artifacts as evidence of process, and have one frictionless path to make contact — all without a single broken link, missing image, or 'coming soon' placeholder.

| Metric              | Definition                                                                | Target                         |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Deployed            | Live at public URL, accessible without login                              | Binary — yes or no             |
| Artifact visibility | PMD artifacts (PRD, Roadmap) visible and readable on-site                 | Binary — yes or no             |
| Vision copy         | Above-fold copy communicates site vision and process in ≤2 sentences each | Binary — yes or no             |
| Contact path        | Email address visible and correctly formatted                             | Binary — yes or no             |
| Monthly visitors    | Raw count via any analytics tool                                          | Baseline established at launch |

*Out of Scope — P0:* Style guide, GitHub environments, A/B testing, event tracking beyond visitor count, responsive optimization, CTA click-through rate, conversion tracking, contact form, broken links check.

## 3 · USER STORIES

### Persona #2 — The Hiring Evaluator

- As a hiring evaluator, I want to see artifact examples so that I know the candidate is capable of producing the role's requisite scope of work.
- As a hiring evaluator, I want to quickly learn what the candidate's projects are and why they chose these specific examples so I can better understand their product mindset.
- As a hiring evaluator, I want to contact the candidate so that I can set up an interview.

### Persona #1 — The Product Manager

- As a product manager, I want to send a single URL to a hiring evaluator so that they can immediately access my portfolio without any login or download required.
- As a product manager, I want to utilize CI/CD so I can make local content changes and seamlessly deploy updates to the live site without taking it offline.
- As a product manager, I want to integrate Google Analytics so that I can quantify site visitors and establish a baseline traffic metric.

*Out of Scope — P0: Artifact detail drill-down, success metric visualizations, A/B testing, CMS, SEO tracking, scalable architecture patterns.*

### 4 · FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

| ID    | Requirement                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Persona |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| FR-01 | Custom Domain — The site shall be accessible via a clean, personal top-level domain without platform subdomains (e.g. no wix.mysite.com, webflow.mysite.com). A valid URL shall return the live site with no 404 errors.                                            | P1      |
| FR-02 | Static Render — When the URL loads, all page content shall render completely without requiring any additional user action, login, or download. The site shall be responsive across mobile, tablet, and desktop screen sizes.                                        | P1      |
| FR-03 | CI/CD Deployment — When the product manager commits changes locally, an integrated CI/CD workflow shall deploy those changes to the live site without uptime interruption.                                                                                          | P1      |
| FR-04 | Analytics — The site shall include a Google Analytics snippet that captures and reports visitor traffic to the product manager's dashboard.                                                                                                                         | P1      |
| FR-05 | Above-Fold Artifact Thumbnails — The site shall render thumbnail images of PMD artifacts above the fold, each paired with a brief text label identifying the artifact type.                                                                                         | P2      |
| FR-06 | Above-Fold Vision Copy — The site shall render concise copy above the fold communicating the site's product purpose, vision, and reason for creation in two sentences or fewer per concept.                                                                         | P2      |
| FR-07 | Below-Fold Artifact Detail — The site shall render a larger image and descriptive 'what' and 'why' copy for each artifact below the fold, reachable by scrolling, providing sufficient detail for a hiring evaluator to assess PM thinking without navigating away. | P2      |
| FR-08 | Contact Path — The site shall display the owner's email address in plain visible text, requiring no interaction to reveal.                                                                                                                                          | P2      |

*Out of Scope — P0: Clickable artifact links, modal overlays, contact form, artifact filtering, navigation menu, external links.*

### 5 · TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

#### Stack

| Layer           | Decision                | Rationale                                               |
|-----------------|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Build tool      | Claude Code             | AI-assisted development. Primary execution tool for P0. |
| Frontend        | HTML / CSS / Vanilla JS | No framework overhead. Static page, zero dependencies.  |
| Version control | GitHub                  | Industry standard. Free. CI/CD integration native.      |

|                |                        |                                                                                        |
|----------------|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hosting        | Netlify (recommended)  | Free tier. Custom domain support. CI/CD on push. Simpler DNS config than GitHub Pages. |
| Domain         | ThePMDev.com           | Already owned. Connect to Netlify via DNS configuration.                               |
| Analytics      | Google Analytics (GA4) | Free. Industry standard. Single snippet, no backend required.                          |
| Design tooling | None at P0             | See Strategy B decision below.                                                         |
| PM tooling     | None at P0             | See Strategy B decision below.                                                         |

### Tooling — Strategy B Decision · Documented Tradeoff · April 2026

Professional PM tooling — Figma, Notion, Jira, Confluence — was evaluated and deliberately deferred for P0.

**The tension:** Full tool adoption before building maximizes professional skill signal but introduces learning curve costs that threaten the 10-day OKR. Every hour configuring Jira sprints is an hour not shipping.

**The decision:** Ship P0 first using Claude Code and GitHub as the only required tools. Introduce professional tooling progressively from P1 forward, where each tool is adopted in service of a real workflow need rather than as a setup exercise.

**The PM rationale:** Strategy B produces a stronger hiring signal than Strategy A — because it demonstrates the ability to ship under constraint, make deliberate tradeoff decisions, and sequence complexity appropriately. The tools will be demonstrated. They will not be prerequisites.

**Deferred to P1+:** Figma (wireframing), Notion (PRD documentation), Jira (sprint planning and story points), Confluence (asset and documentation management).

### CI/CD Workflow

Local development → GitHub commit → Netlify auto-deploy → ThePMDev.com live with zero downtime.

### Constraints

- Static site only — no backend, no database, no server-side logic at P0.
- All content hardcoded — no CMS.
- Responsive across mobile, tablet, and desktop — built in from day one.
- Total build time target: ≤10 days from PRD approval.